Lingual Braces

Orthodontic Care Suggested URL: `/orthodontic-care/lingual-braces`

Straighten Your Teeth Without Brackets on the Front

If you want to improve your tooth alignment while keeping your braces hidden from view, lingual braces may be an option worth exploring. Unlike conventional braces, which are attached to the front surfaces of the teeth, lingual braces are fixed to the inner surfaces facing the tongue.

They use brackets and orthodontic wires to move teeth gradually according to a personalised treatment plan. Because the braces sit behind the teeth, they are much less visible when you smile or speak.

Lingual braces require careful planning and specialist expertise. Their suitability depends on your bite, tooth position, treatment goals and comfort preferences.

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What Makes Lingual Braces Different?

Lingual braces work on the same general principle as traditional fixed braces, but their placement changes how they look and feel.

Hidden placement: Brackets are attached to the inner surfaces of the teeth, making them difficult to see from the front.

- Fixed treatment: The braces remain attached throughout treatment and are adjusted by the orthodontist.

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- Personalised tooth movement: The orthodontist plans the wire and bracket system to address the individual alignment problem.

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- A discreet alternative: They may suit people who prefer fixed braces without visible front brackets.

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Lingual braces are not removable like clear aligners. Although they are discreet, they can take time to get used to because the brackets sit close to the tongue.

Who Might Consider Lingual Braces?

Lingual braces may be suitable for adults and selected teenagers who want a discreet way to correct their teeth. The orthodontist will assess whether the system can address the specific alignment and bite concerns.

They may be considered for:

- Crowded teeth: When teeth overlap or lack enough space.

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- Gaps between teeth: When spacing needs orthodontic correction.

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- Rotated teeth: When individual teeth need repositioning.

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- Selected bite problems: When the upper and lower teeth do not meet correctly and lingual braces are suitable for the planned movements.

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Lingual braces are not the best option for every case. Your orthodontist may recommend another treatment if the bite, tooth shape or complexity of the required movement makes lingual braces unsuitable.

Your Treatment Journey: From Planning to Retention

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1. Orthodontic assessment

Your orthodontist examines your teeth, bite and gum health. Photographs, digital scans and X-rays may be used to plan the treatment.

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2. Placing the braces

The brackets are attached to the inner surfaces of your teeth and connected with orthodontic wires according to your treatment plan.

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3. Monitoring tooth movement

Regular appointments allow the orthodontist to assess progress and make adjustments. You may need some time to adapt to the sensation of the braces against your tongue.

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4. Retaining your results

Once the braces are removed, your orthodontist will recommend retainers to help maintain the corrected tooth positions.

The Adjustment Period: Speech, Comfort and Cleaning

Because lingual braces sit close to the tongue, the first few days or weeks may feel different from wearing conventional braces. Some people notice temporary speech changes, tongue irritation or difficulty getting comfortable while eating.

You can make the adjustment period easier by following a few simple habits:

- Practise speaking normally and allow yourself time to adapt.

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- Choose softer foods initially if your teeth or tongue feel tender.

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- Brush carefully around the brackets and along the gum line.

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- Use suitable interdental cleaning aids recommended by your orthodontist.

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- Avoid hard or sticky foods that may damage brackets or wires.

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- Contact your orthodontist if a wire repeatedly irritates your tongue or a bracket becomes loose.

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Keeping the inner surfaces of your teeth clean can take extra care with lingual braces. Good oral hygiene helps reduce the risk of gum inflammation, decay and white spots on the teeth.

Lingual Braces vs Other Orthodontic Options

Choosing an orthodontic system involves more than appearance. Consider the differences before deciding which treatment to discuss with your orthodontist.

Feature	Lingual braces	Ceramic braces	Clear aligners
Visibility	Hidden behind the teeth	Tooth-coloured brackets on the front	Usually clear removable trays
Removable	No	No	Yes
Speech adjustment	May affect speech initially	Usually less tongue interference	Some people notice temporary changes

Cleaning	Requires careful cleaning behind teeth	Requires careful cleaning around brackets	Trays are removed for cleaning
Best choice	Depends on bite and treatment needs	Depends on alignment and preference	Depends on case suitability and wear compliance

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There is no single best option for everyone. Your orthodontist can explain the expected treatment duration, practical considerations and cost of each suitable approach.

Frequently Asked Questions

1. Are lingual braces completely invisible?

They are much less visible than braces attached to the front of the teeth because the brackets sit on the inner surfaces. They may still be noticeable in certain situations, such as when the mouth is opened widely.

2. Do lingual braces affect speech?

They can temporarily affect pronunciation because the tongue comes into contact with the brackets. Most people adapt over time, although the adjustment period varies.

3. Are lingual braces painful?

Some pressure, tooth tenderness and tongue irritation are common initially or after adjustments. Your orthodontist can suggest ways to manage discomfort.

4. How long does lingual braces treatment take?

Treatment duration depends on the complexity of the case, the tooth movements required and individual progress. Your orthodontist can estimate the likely duration after an examination.

5. Can lingual braces correct crowded teeth and gaps?

They can treat many alignment problems, including selected cases of crowding and spacing. Suitability depends on your bite and the movements required.

6. Are lingual braces harder to clean?

Cleaning can be more challenging because the brackets are behind the teeth. Specialised brushes and careful daily cleaning can help maintain oral health.

7. Are lingual braces better than clear aligners?

Neither is automatically better. Lingual braces are fixed and discreet, while clear aligners are removable and depend on consistent wear. The right choice depends on your treatment needs and preferences.

Discover a More Discreet Orthodontic Option at Jerush

You can work towards a straighter smile while choosing an orthodontic option that fits your preferences. Lingual braces offer a discreet fixed approach, but a personalised assessment is essential to determine whether they are suitable for your teeth and bite.

At Jerush Dentofacial & Cosmetic Laser Centre, an orthodontic consultation can help you explore lingual braces and other treatment options based on your dental needs.

Prefer braces that stay out of sight? Book an orthodontic consultation to discuss whether lingual braces may be right for you.

Add dr bladbin here

SEO recommendations

- SEO title: Lingual Braces Treatment for Discreet Teeth Straightening | Jerush
- Meta description: Discover lingual braces, the discreet orthodontic option fitted behind your teeth. Learn about suitability, treatment, comfort and aftercare at Jerush.
- Primary keyword: Lingual braces
- Related keywords: Invisible braces, braces behind teeth, lingual orthodontics, discreet teeth straightening, orthodontic treatment
- Suggested image alt text: `Lingual braces fitted to the inner surfaces of teeth for discreet orthodontic treatment`